

WEBSITE PROJECT BRIEF

Thambalagama Estate Villa

Sri Lanka | Exclusive Private Nature Retreat

1. About the Business

What does the business do?

This property rents out a single large luxury bungalow villa privately located within the Sinharaja Rainforest buffer zone in Sri Lanka. Guests book the entire property exclusively, meaning no other guests share the space during their stay. The bungalow sleeps up to 18 guests across multiple rooms and is designed to serve couples, families, small groups, and nature enthusiasts looking for a genuinely private, immersive forest retreat. The estate sits approximately 7 km from the Lankagama gate entrance to the Sinharaja World Heritage Forest, about a 15-minute drive from the main border, with the Sinharaja forest boundary running directly alongside the property.

Property Overview (Full Inventory)

The bungalow estate includes the following spaces and features:

Sleeping and Bathroom Accommodation

- 18 guest beds across multiple rooms
- 5 rooms with attached private bathrooms
- 4 air-conditioned rooms (4 persons per room)
- 1 air-conditioned room (2 persons, ideal for couples)

Living and Utility Spaces

- 1 large living room
- 1 fully equipped kitchen
- 2 storage room
- 2 office rooms (usable as additional working or private spaces)

Outdoor and Recreational Features

- 2 natural waterfalls located inside the estate
- 1 natural swimming pool
- Clubhouse
- BBQ area

- Balcony with open 360-degree panoramic view over Sinharaja forest and surrounding landscape

Location and Access

- Located inside the Sinharaja Rainforest buffer zone
 - 7 km from Lankagama gate, approximately 15 minutes to the Sinharaja border entrance
 - Property sits directly on the Sinharaja border
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Why Does This Business Exist?

The owners believe the best holidays happen when guests are completely surrounded by nature with zero distractions. The goal was to build a place where guests can fully disconnect, breathe fresh forest air, and feel like the entire rainforest belongs to them. Having two natural waterfalls and a natural pool on the property itself makes this one of the most unique private retreat settings in all of Sri Lanka.

What Makes This Property Different?

Guests book the entire 18-guest bungalow estate, not a single room in a shared resort. It is completely private. The estate contains two private waterfalls and a natural swimming pool within its own grounds. The location inside the Sinharaja UNESCO World Heritage Rainforest buffer zone, directly on the forest border, is something no other luxury property in Sri Lanka can match. Guests have guided access to over 9 waterfalls, Sinharaja forest trails, bird watching, and wildlife photography directly from the property.

Products and Services Offered

Main Offering

- Full exclusive hire of the 18-guest bungalow estate (private, no shared guests)

What Is Included

- Guided forest walk inside Sinharaja

Optional Add-Ons

- In-villa dining with a private chef (guests can choose their menu)
 - Guided waterfall trails with experienced local guides
 - Sinharaja forest walks and nature tours with guidance
 - Bird watching experiences (property is noted as excellent for endemic Sri Lankan birds, referenced by the client as a key feature for bird lovers and wildlife photographers)
 - Wildlife photography guidance
 - BBQ evenings
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2. Audience and Market

Ideal Visitor Profile

- Couples aged 25 to 55 looking for a romantic private escape in a luxury nature setting.
- Small groups of 4 to 6 friends or extended families (the estate supports up to 18 guests, making it ideal for larger family reunions, group retreats, or milestone celebrations).
- Nature enthusiasts, bird watchers, wildlife photographers, and eco-travel seekers who specifically come to Sri Lanka for Sinharaja and endemic wildlife. These guests will be strongly drawn by the direct forest border location, the 9 accessible waterfalls, and the property waterfalls and pool.

All ideal guests share these traits:

- Strong desire for privacy and exclusivity
 - Willing to pay premium rates for something genuinely unique and off the beaten track
 - Drawn to authentic natural settings rather than resort pools and beach clubs
 - Likely to research carefully before booking (this is a considered, high-value purchase)
 - Value personal communication and want to speak to the owners before committing
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Devices Guests Use

- Mobile phone (primary)
- Laptop
- Desktop computer
- Tablet

Note: The website must perform exceptionally well on mobile. Many guests will first discover the property on Instagram or while browsing on a phone. First impressions on a small screen matter enormously.

How Guests Find the Property Today

- Not for Now
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Accessibility Considerations

No specific accessibility requirements have been flagged. However, the client has noted that some guests are older travellers, so the website should use large, highly readable text throughout. Minimum body font size should be 17px or equivalent, and contrast ratios must be strong. Navigation must be simple and unambiguous.

3. Competitors and Inspiration

Main Competitors

Srilanka Tourism Department Website: <https://www.sltda.gov.lk/en>

Website Inspiration

4. Current Website Assessment

Current Traffic Data

5. Goals for the New Website

Primary Emotional Goal

When someone lands on the website, they should feel like they are already there. Surrounded by the forest. Standing on the balcony looking at the 360-degree view. Hearing the waterfalls. The website needs to create that feeling before they have even read a single line of text.

Primary Conversion Goal

The business does not expect or require instant online bookings. This is a high-value, considered purchase. The primary conversion goal is to get the visitor to send an enquiry. From there, the owners speak to the guest personally and close the booking in conversation.

Every page, every call to action, and every design decision must point toward one outcome: the guest sending an enquiry.

Secondary Goal

Even if a visitor does not enquire immediately, the website should be memorable enough that they return. Word of mouth and repeat research are both important in this market. The site should leave a lasting impression.

How the Website Should Feel

- Warm and personal, as though the owners are talking directly to the guest

- Luxurious without being cold or corporate
 - Natural and earthy, rooted in the forest setting
 - Clean and minimal, nothing cluttered, photography does the heavy lifting
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6. Pages and Site Structure

Required Pages

Home

Hero section with full-screen immersive photography or video. Immediate emotional impact. Short headline that captures what the property is. Quick introduction to what makes it unique. Clear call to action to send an enquiry.

The Bungalow

Detailed page about the villa itself. Full room inventory (18 beds, 5 attached bathrooms, 4 AC rooms, the 2-person suite, living room, kitchen). Showcase the balcony with 360-degree views, bar area, clubhouse, and BBQ. Photography-led layout.

The Forest

About the Sinharaja UNESCO World Heritage Rainforest and what it means to stay right on its border. Distance to Lankagama gate (7 km, 15 minutes). What guests can experience: forest trails, 9 waterfalls, endemic birds, wildlife. The natural pool and two estate waterfalls should be prominently featured here.

Experiences

All the things guests can do: guided forest walks, waterfall trails, Sinharaja forest tours, bird watching, wildlife photography, private yoga, in-villa dining with chef-chosen or guest-selected menus, BBQ evenings. Presented as curated experiences, not just a list.

Gallery

Full image gallery. Drone shots, interior photos, forest and waterfall imagery. No stock photos. Everything must be real and authentic to this property. Large format, immersive layout.

FAQ

Answers to common questions: what is included, how to get there, best time to visit, how booking works, how many guests the property holds, nearest airport, etc.

About

The story of the property and the owners. Personal and warm. This is where the Love Hotel tone of voice is most important. Why they built it, what they believe, what they hope guests feel.

Contact / Enquiry

Simple, clean enquiry form. Name, number of guests, preferred dates, message. Phone number and email visible. This is the primary conversion page. Nothing should distract from the form.

Special Features Required

Availability Calendar

A calendar showing available and blocked dates is critical. Guests need to be able to check availability before enquiring. This reduces friction in the enquiry process and sets expectations early. The calendar must be easily updated by the owners without developer help.

Interactive Map

A map showing where the property sits in relation to Sinharaja forest, the Lankagama gate, nearby towns, and major airports. Helps guests understand the location before booking.

Enquiry / Contact Form

Simple form: name, email, phone, dates, number of guests, message. Submissions should go directly to the owners by email and ideally also be stored in a simple backend or CMS.

Languages

English only for now. No multilingual requirement at launch.

Domain Name

thambalagamaestate.com
thambalagamaestate.lk

Content Management

The owners need to be able to update availability, pricing, and photos themselves without calling a developer. The choice of CMS should prioritise ease of use for non-technical users.

7. Photography and Visual Assets

Photography is the single biggest asset this property has. The client has high-quality drone shots and interior photos that have never been properly used. The new website must be built around these images. Every key page should lead with photography, not text.

Guidelines for photography use on the website:

- No stock photography under any circumstances. All images must be real and authentic to this property.
- Drone shots of the estate and surrounding Sinharaja forest canopy should be used on the home hero and the Forest page.

- Interior photography of bedrooms, the living room, bar, and balcony for The Bungalow page.
- Waterfall and natural pool photography for the Experiences and Forest pages.
- Bird and wildlife photography for the Experiences page.
- BBQ, dining, and lifestyle shots for the Experiences page.
- Sunrise and sunset views from the 360-degree balcony should be featured prominently.

8. Technical Summary

Feature	Requirement
Language	English only
Domain	thambalagamaestate.com
CMS	Required. Owner must manage content without developer help
Availability calendar	Required. Owner-managed. Guests must see dates before enquiring
Interactive map	Required. Show property location relative to Sinharaja
Enquiry form	Required. Primary conversion goal for all pages
Mobile performance	Critical. Many guests discover via Instagram on mobile
Typography	Large, readable text throughout. Minimum 17px body. Strong contrast
Photography	Full-screen, image-led design. No stock photos. Real property images only
Launch deadline	5 Weeks

9. Anything Else

Key Notes from Client

- The client specifically highlighted bird watching and wildlife photography as a major draw for a certain type of guest. The website should have clear dedicated content for this audience within the Experiences page.
- The estate has 9 accessible waterfalls via guided trails, plus 2 private waterfalls on the property itself. Both should be communicated clearly as major selling points.

- The private chef with a guest-selectable menu is an important premium add-on that differentiates the property from standard lodges. Feature this prominently in the Experiences page.
- The Dulli Alla trail is mentioned as a specific local trail offering. This should be included in the Experiences page as a named, guided experience.
- The open 360-degree view balcony is one of the most visually dramatic features of the property. It should appear in photography across multiple pages, not just The Bungalow.
- The bar area is an interior feature worth featuring in gallery and bungalow photography to support the luxury positioning.
- The client currently has no domain name. This is a project task.
- All content, photography, and copywriting should feel authentic and personal. The warmth of the owner must come through everywhere.

Document prepared from client brief and sketch notes.